

Task 7

Analyze the threat of five recent DDoS attacks, and your assignment is to each select one of these incidents to investigate. .You are required to research your chosen attack and prepare a brief summary covering the target, the technology used, the attacker's motive, the overall impact, and the defensive strategies that could have mitigated it.

Prepared by: Richu Joseph

1. Five Recent DDos Attacks

- **Global hyper-volumetric attacks — Cloudflare (7.3 Tbps, May–Jun 2025)**
A 7.3 Tbps attack was mitigated by Cloudflare against a hosting provider. It used UDP/packet floods and highlighted the growing power of IoT and cloud-sourced botnets.
- **Record follow-ups — Cloudflare (11.5–22.2 Tbps, Aug–Oct 2025)**
Multiple record-breaking DDoS events followed, peaking up to 22.2 Tbps. Automated mitigation and anycast distribution prevented global outages.
- **Gaming platform disruptions — Steam, Riot, PlayStation, Epic, Xbox (Oct 6–7, 2025)**
A global disruption hit multiple gaming networks simultaneously. Analysts suspected massive volumetric DDoS floods and carpet-bombing techniques.
- **Pro-Russian DDoS campaigns — Ukraine (2024–2025)**
Hacktivist groups like NoName057 (16) repeatedly attacked Ukrainian media and government services using volumetric and application-layer DDoS techniques.

- Media outlet DDoS — Kyiv Independent (July 2025)
Independent media faced targeted DDoS attacks aimed at silencing coverage. Thousands of requests per second overwhelmed site infrastructure.

2. Detailed Analysis of Global Gaming Platform DDoS Outage (October 2025)

Target

Major gaming platforms including Steam, Riot Games, PlayStation Network, Epic Games, and Xbox experienced massive service outages beginning October 6, 2025. Users worldwide were unable to access matchmaking, authentication, and online play.

Technology Used

The attacks involved high-bandwidth TCP/UDP floods and carpet-bombing across multiple IPs, leveraging IoT and cloud-hosted botnets. Peak estimates (unverified) ranged into tens of terabits per second. Some reports linked the Aisuru botnet as a potential source.

Attacker Motive

The motive was not confirmed, but possible reasons include protest actions by hacktivists, stress-testing of new botnets, or attempts to showcase DDoS-for-hire capabilities.

Overall Impact

The outages disrupted millions of players globally. Online services and transactions were interrupted for several hours. The attacks also strained infrastructure providers and required large-scale traffic rerouting and scrubbing operations.

Defensive Strategies

- Anycast routing and distributed scrubbing centers to absorb attack traffic.
- Upstream ISP filtering and blackhole routing to block volumetric floods.

- Rate limiting, connection caps, and challenge-response systems at network edges.
- Content Delivery Networks (CDNs) and failover mechanisms for critical services.
- Industry-wide adoption of BCP38 and IoT device hardening to reduce botnet growth.

3. Conclusion

The October 2025 gaming platform DDoS incident illustrates the continuing evolution of distributed denial-of-service threats. Modern DDoS attacks combine massive bandwidth with intelligent targeting, making automated mitigation and distributed defense essential. Organizations must invest in layered protection, cooperative ISP defenses, and real-time analytics to reduce downtime and financial loss.